

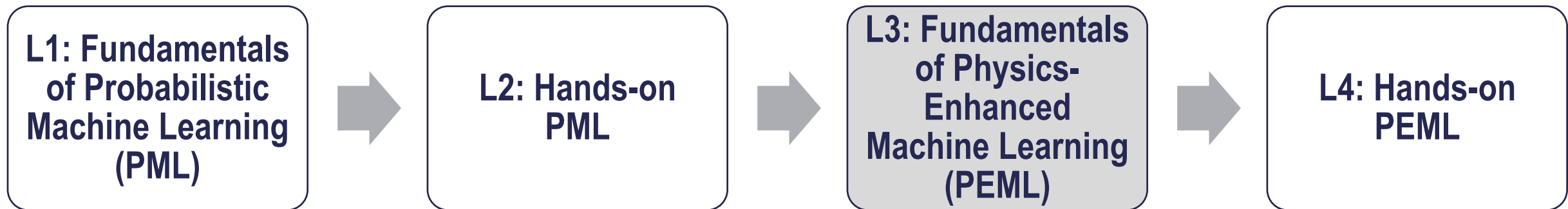
Physics-Enhanced Machine Learning

Lecturer: Alice Cicirello (ac685@cam.ac.uk)

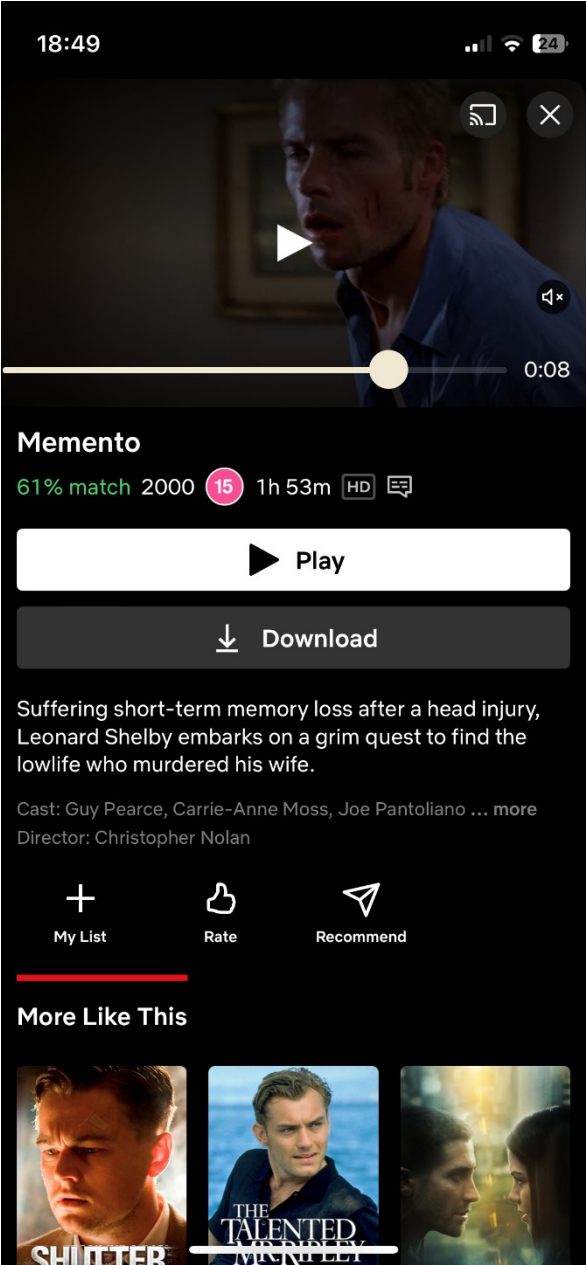
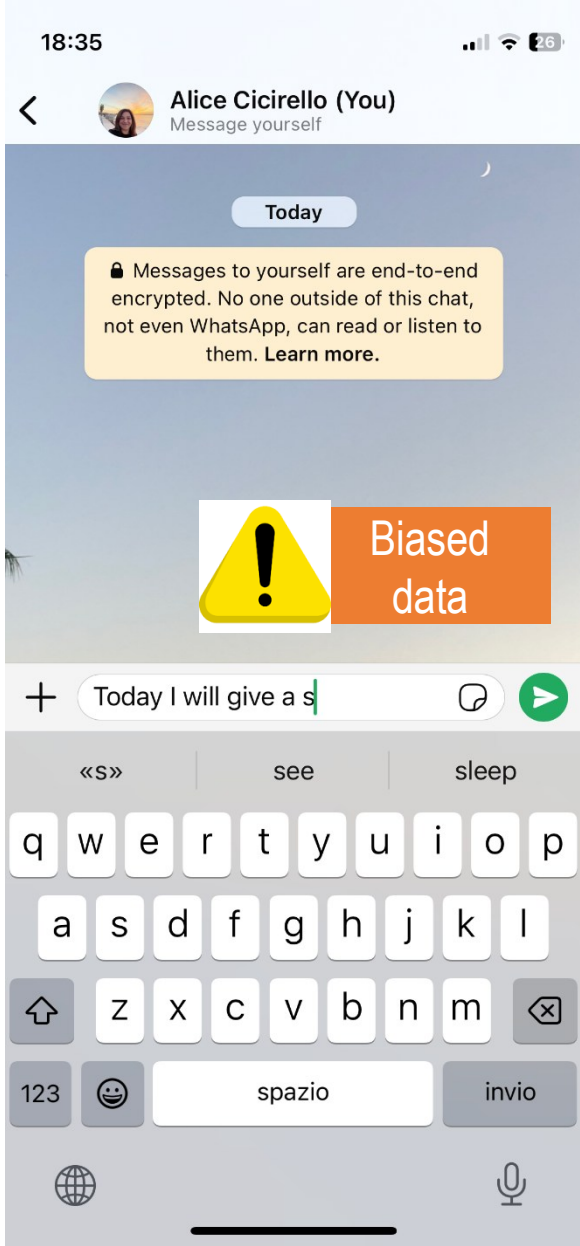
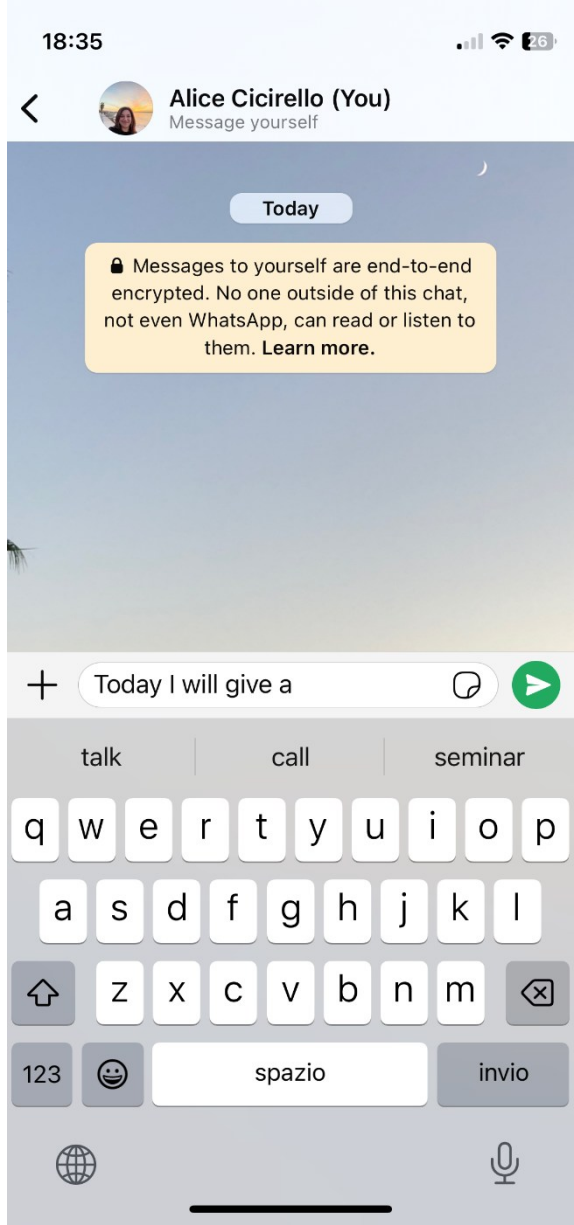
Learning objectives of this lecture

Physics-Enhanced Machine Learning

- Intro to Physics-Enhanced Machine Learning
- Overview of PEML strategies developed within the DVU group



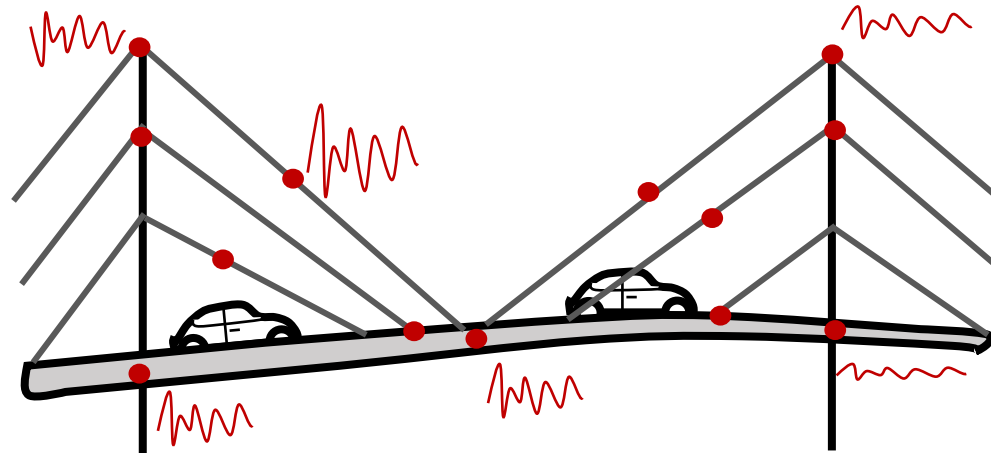
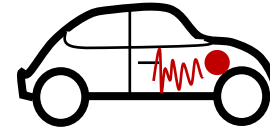
Guiding decision-making: low risk consequences based on data



*I do not own the copyright of these pictures which are shown for educational purpose only – trained on my data

Guiding decision-making in
Engineering has
high risk
consequences!

Can we just use
data? What data?

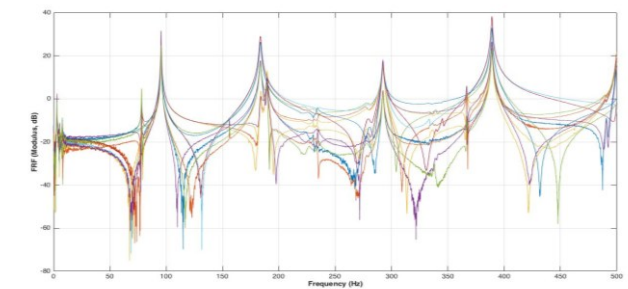
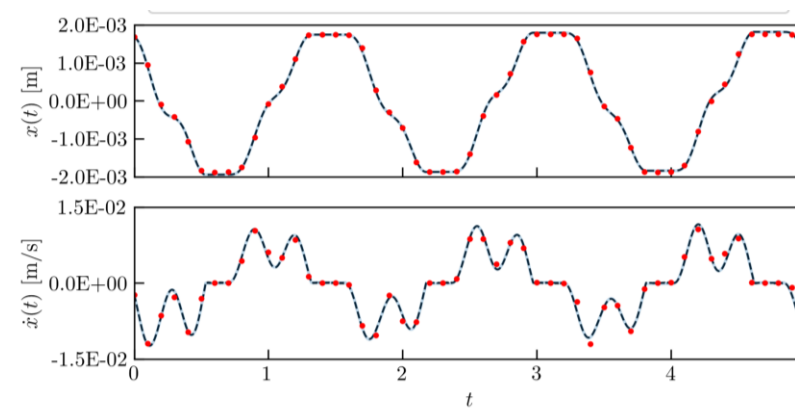
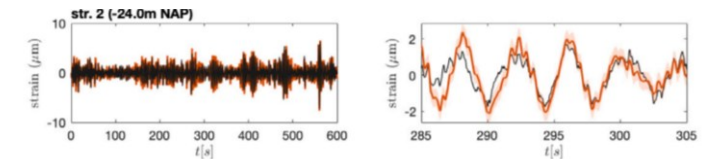
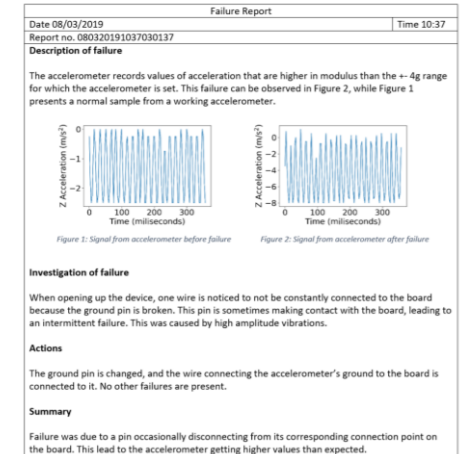
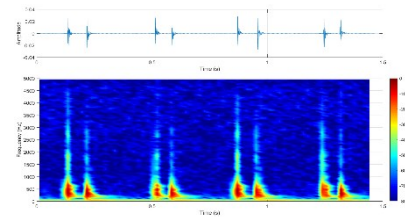
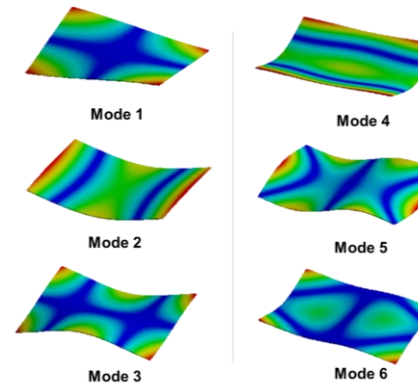


In Engineering we are dealing with **Expensive MUSIC** and **NOISE**

Data is
expensive to acquire,

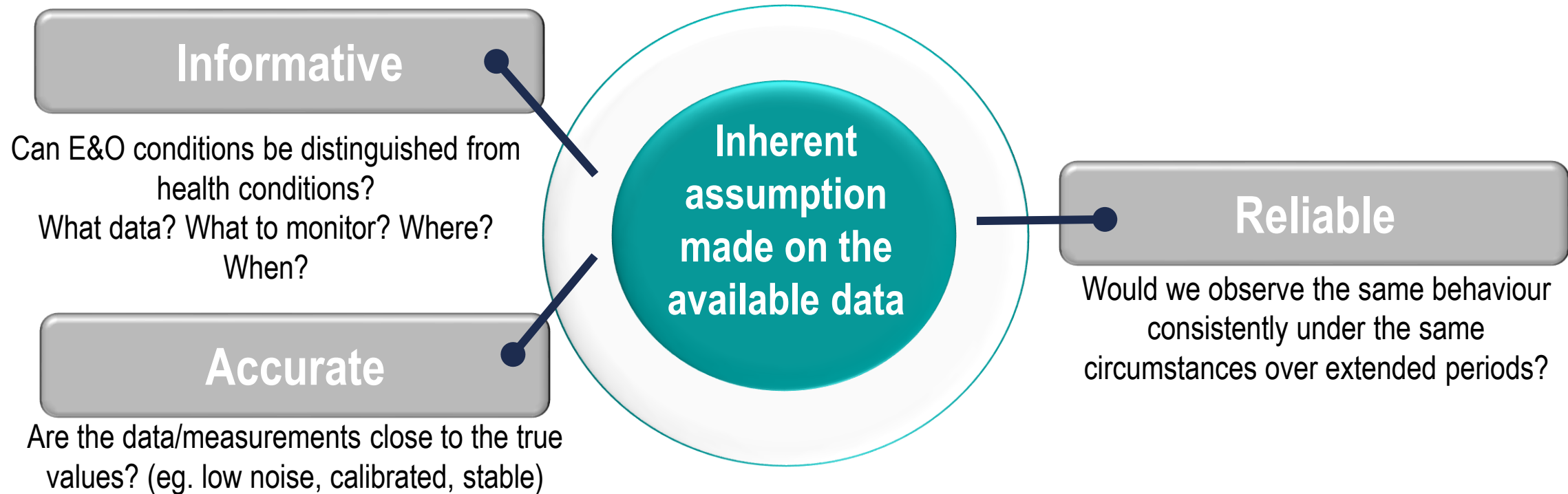
Multimodal, **U**ncertain, **S**parsity,
Incomplete,
and it might be
Corrupted by confounding influences

Non-smooth and
not necessarily **O**bservable
phenomena,
Indirect, **S**imulated data,
and typically, we care about
Extrême events



Data is connected and is not enough!

Data must be transformed in relevant **information**!



Machine Learning Models based on data **will be as good as the data (do we have the right data?!):**

- Not all conditions can be observed and/or **labelled**!
- Do we have the right data for learning something about the task of interest? Is the data **up-to-date**?
- Can we trust the **quality** of the data? (e.g. are there data-biases?, was it collected in a consistent way?)
- Are there **confounding sources**?
- Do we have the **metadata**?

Tackling these challenges with **Physics-Enhanced Machine Learning (PEML)**!

A very difficult integration of physics-data-knowledge challenge!

Mathematical models
(multi-fidelity, multi-scale,
high-dimensional, coupled,...)

Domain knowledge

Prior knowledge
(observational, empirical,
physical, mathematical)

**First principles
& appropriate biases**

Computational strategies

**Dealing with wrong
(physics/model) biases**

**Small, heterogeneous,
gappy, noisy data**
(images, time series lab
test, historical data,
inspection documents,...)

**Multi-fidelity data (different
spatial and temporal
resolution; different quality)**

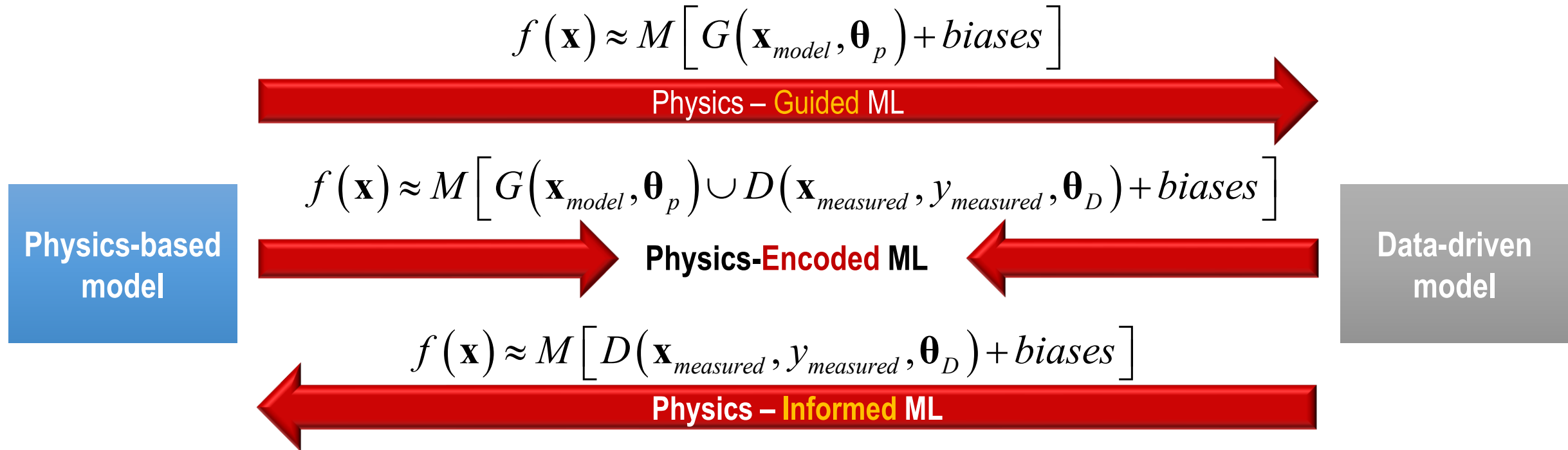
Dealing with corrupted data

**Dealing with non-informative
data**

Dealing with uncertainties

**Providing strategies for
validating solvers and
prediction, forecasting and
simulation models**

- how **much** physics vs data should be included?
 - how are the physics-model, domain knowledge, and data-driven model **integrated**?
- ...led to **several hybrid physics-data models!**



...and several other definitions:

- **Grey-box models/PI spectrum:** E. J. Cross et. al., A spectrum of physics-informed Gaussian processes for regression in engineering. Data Centric Engineering, 2024
- **PEML spectrum:** M. Haywood-Alexander et. all, Discussing the Spectra of Physics-Enhanced Machine Learning via a Survey on Structural Mechanics Applications, DCE 2024
- **Scientific Machine Learning**

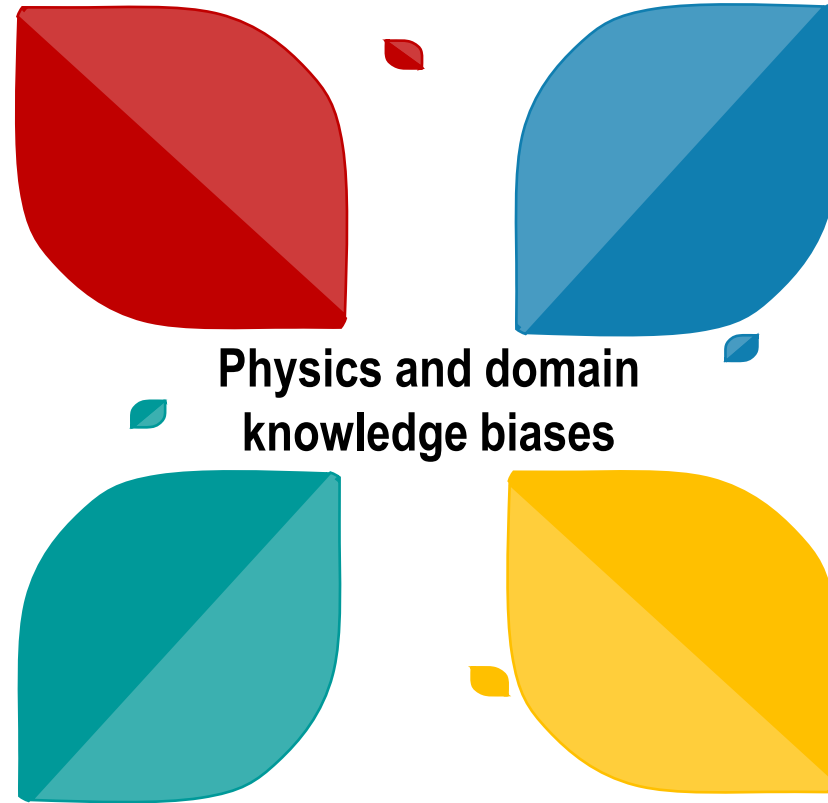
Physics-Enhanced Machine Learning (PEML): Combining data and “good biases”

Observational bias:

Introducing data that embody underlying physics (e.g. lab experiments, simulations, extreme events)

Learning bias:

Implement biases in an appropriate inference/learning algorithm: selection of the algorithm itself, loss functions, optimization/learning algorithm constraints



Inductive bias:

Incorporate prior assumptions and physical constraints that we know of (conservation laws, symmetries, invariances, boundaries)

Model form/discrepancy bias:

Including “terms”, model form, and any form of partial knowledge of a physics-based model (with or without uncertainty)

- constrain **the space of admissible solutions**
- can be combined to **accelerate** training, to **reduce** computational costs and energy consumptions, and to **enhance generalisation** even with limited data
- can be introduced in different parts of the algorithm (not just the loss function!)

(Very ambitious) Goals of Physics- Enhanced Machine Learning (PEML)



Overcoming poor generalization (to unseen conditions/new configurations) performance of ML approaches

Removing physically inconsistent or implausible predictions (e.g. improving control strategies, interaction models) with limited data



Uncertainty Quantification

physics, data, parameter, model form, model error, reducible, irreducible, ... and solver/code uncertainty



Providing **explainable, interpretable, fast and accurate** solutions that can extrapolate to unseen conditions in the data

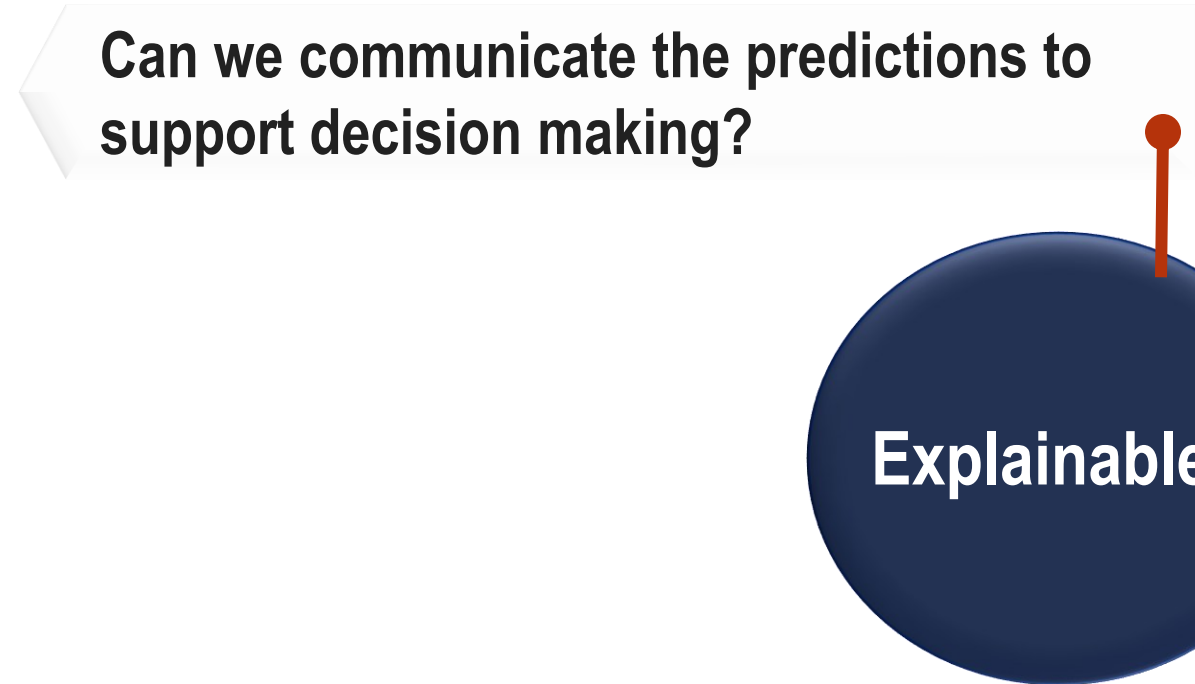
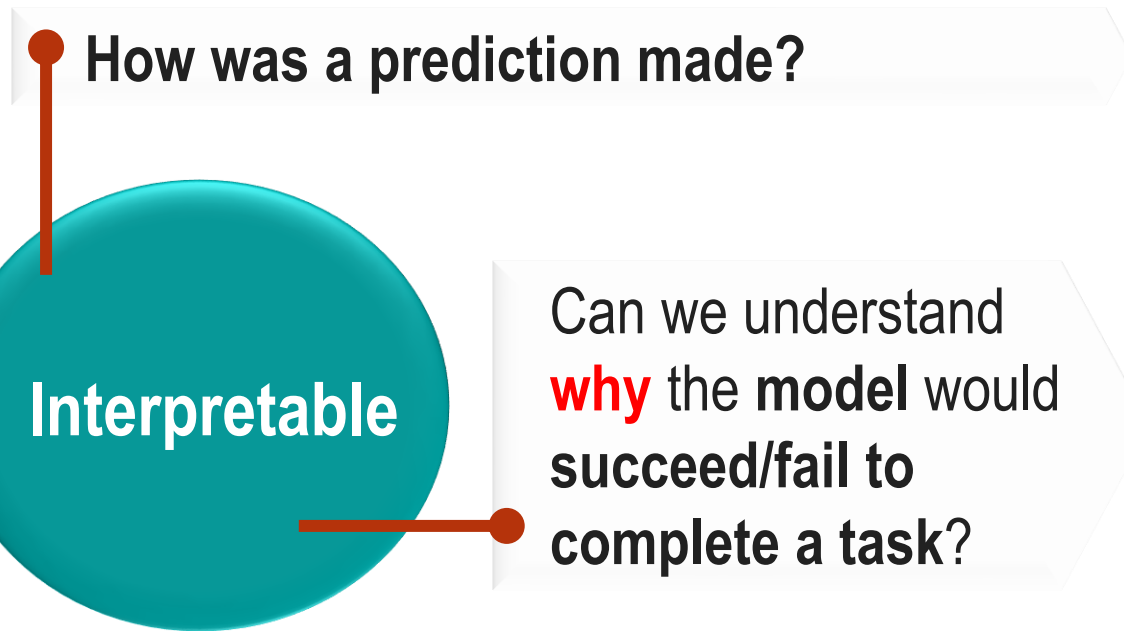


Learning something that we did not know before!

Informing physics: identification of unknown constitutive laws, of physics-model parameters, of governing equations, of reduced order models, of **experiments** to be carried out...

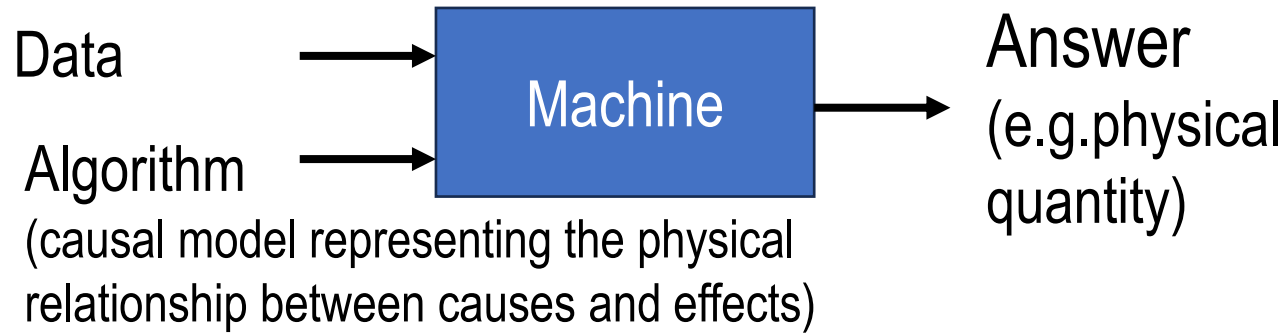
Explainability and interpretability challenges

A definition that might work



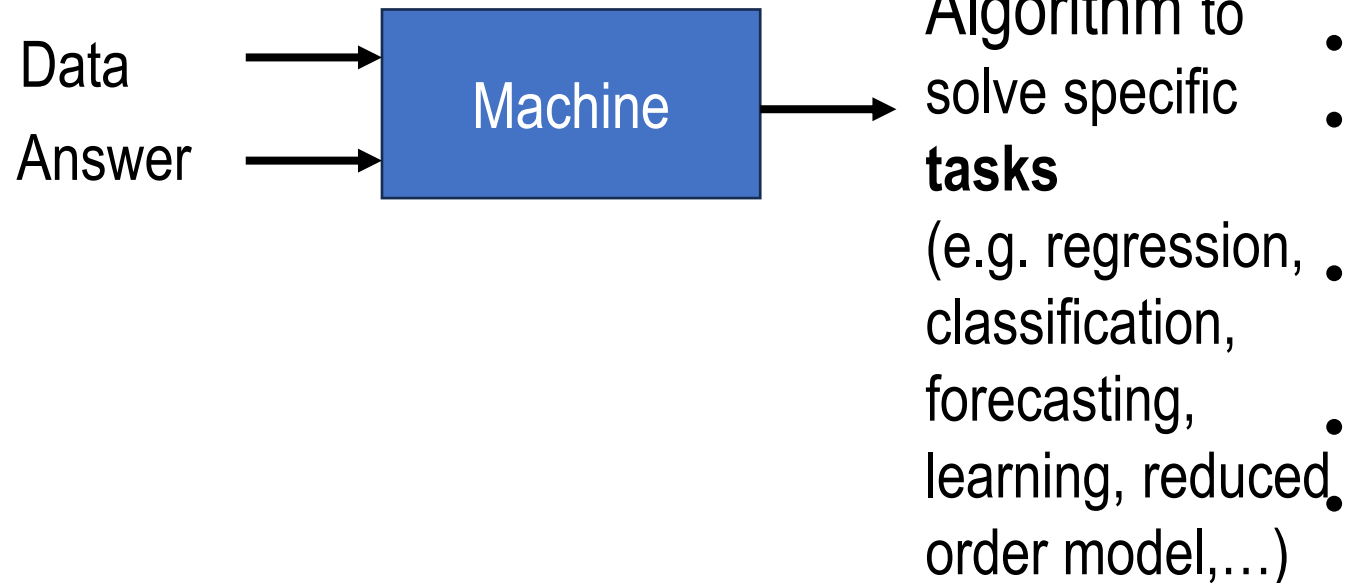
Why would a model succeed/fail to complete a task?

Physics-based model analysis



- incorrect modelling assumptions (assuming a LTI system)
- incorrect physical model parameters
- Inaccurate/inappropriate solver
- ...

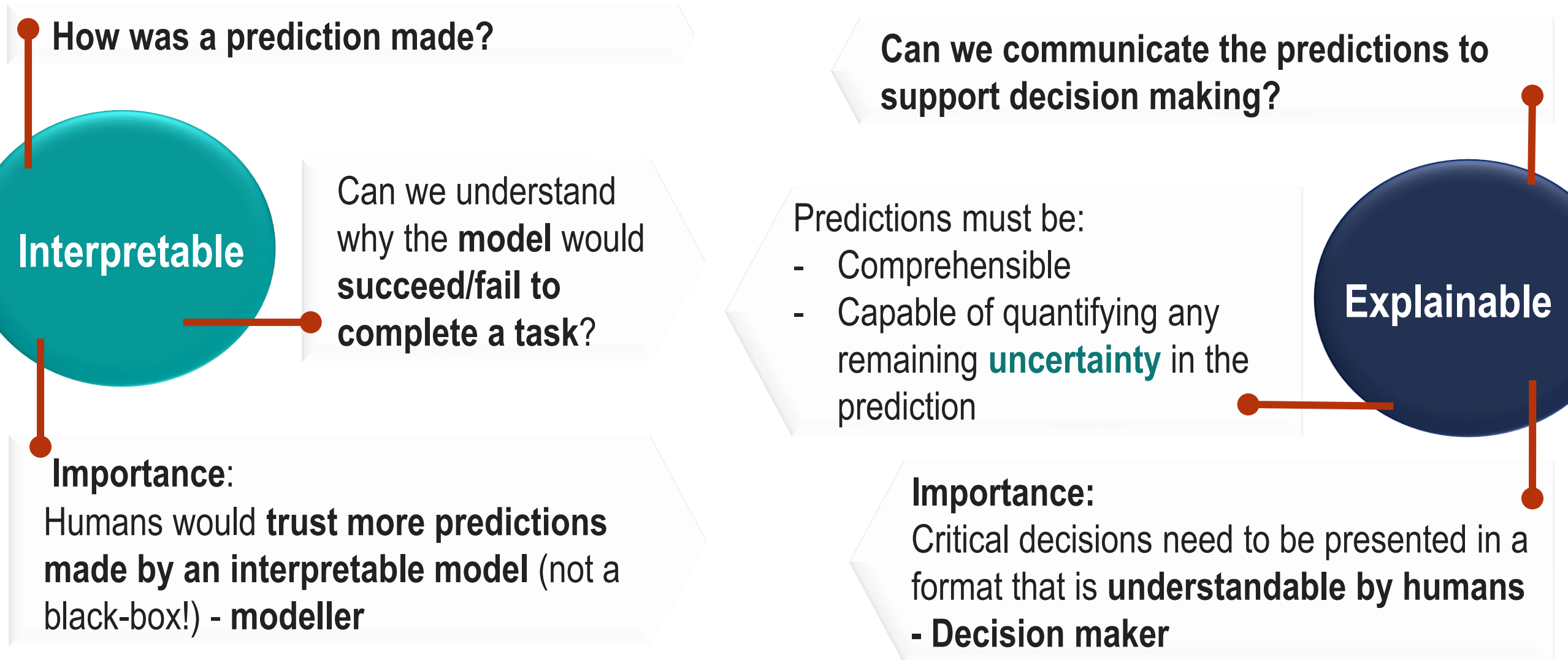
Machine Learning



- local minima, underfitted/overfitted model
- corrupted or non-informative measurements
- correlation and associational evidence that cannot be generalised
- presence of confounding influences not being properly disentangled
- Learning artefacts
- ...

Explainability and interpretability challenges

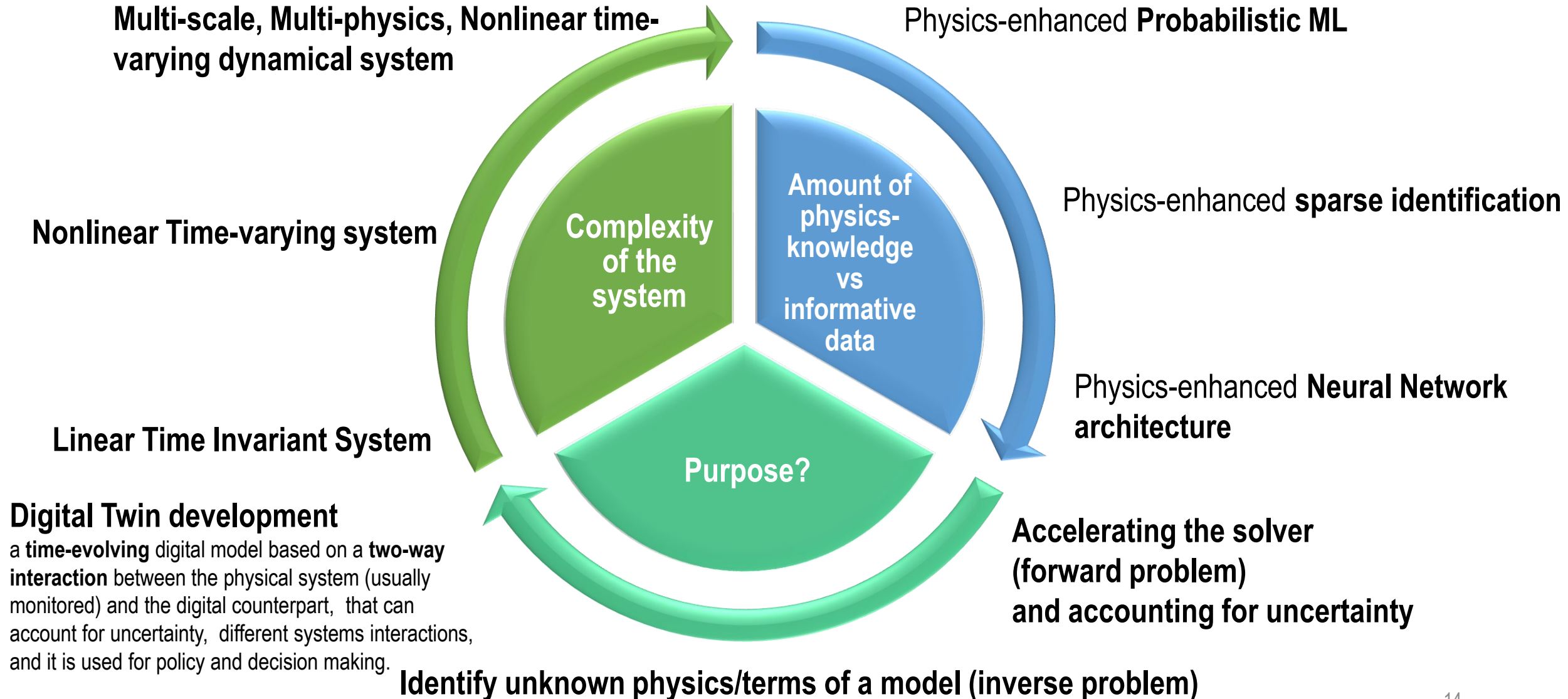
A definition that might work



Which Physics-Enhanced ML (PEML) strategy?

No one size fits all!

Limited to 3 examples for each category...
although there are many more!!!



*All models are wrong
but some are useful*



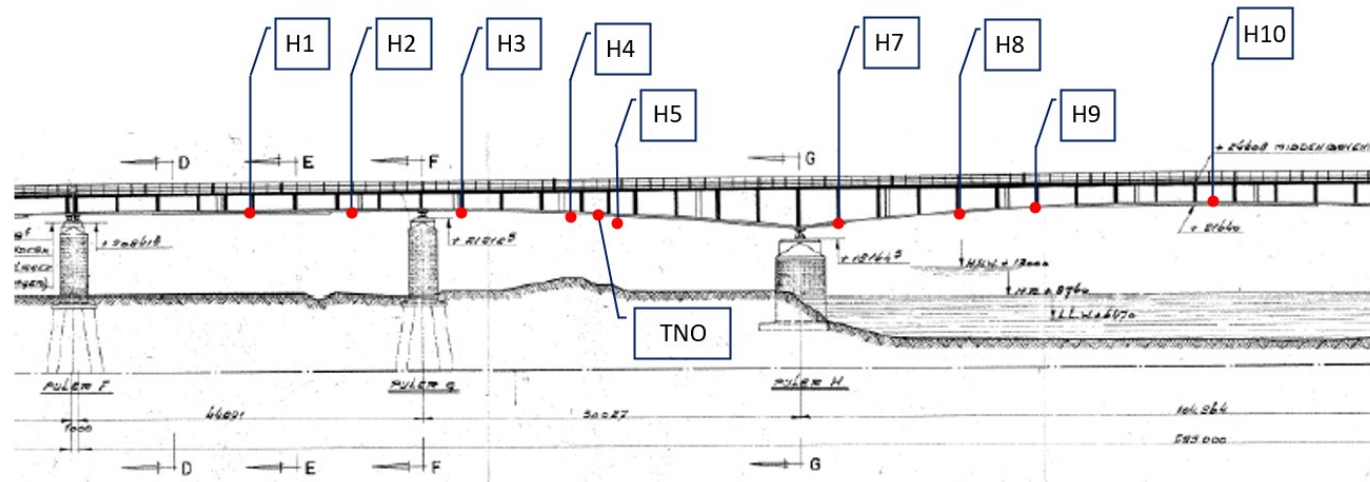
George E.P. Box

Choose wisely depending on the available information!
Don't forget the assumptions, and wrt what dataset they have been validated!

PEML architecture for model updating strategy: bridges

Bayesian system identification for structures considering spatial and temporal correlations

The ijssselbridge: twin girder steel roadbridge strain gauges measurements



In standard model updating strategies spatial and temporal correlations of measurements are **usually ignored**, assumed iid, leading to **wrong posterior distributions of the uncertain parameters**

Physics-guided PEML strategy: Bayesian system identification for structures considering spatial and temporal correlations

Known physics-based model with uncertain parameters

Model form bias

Large number of noisy measurements



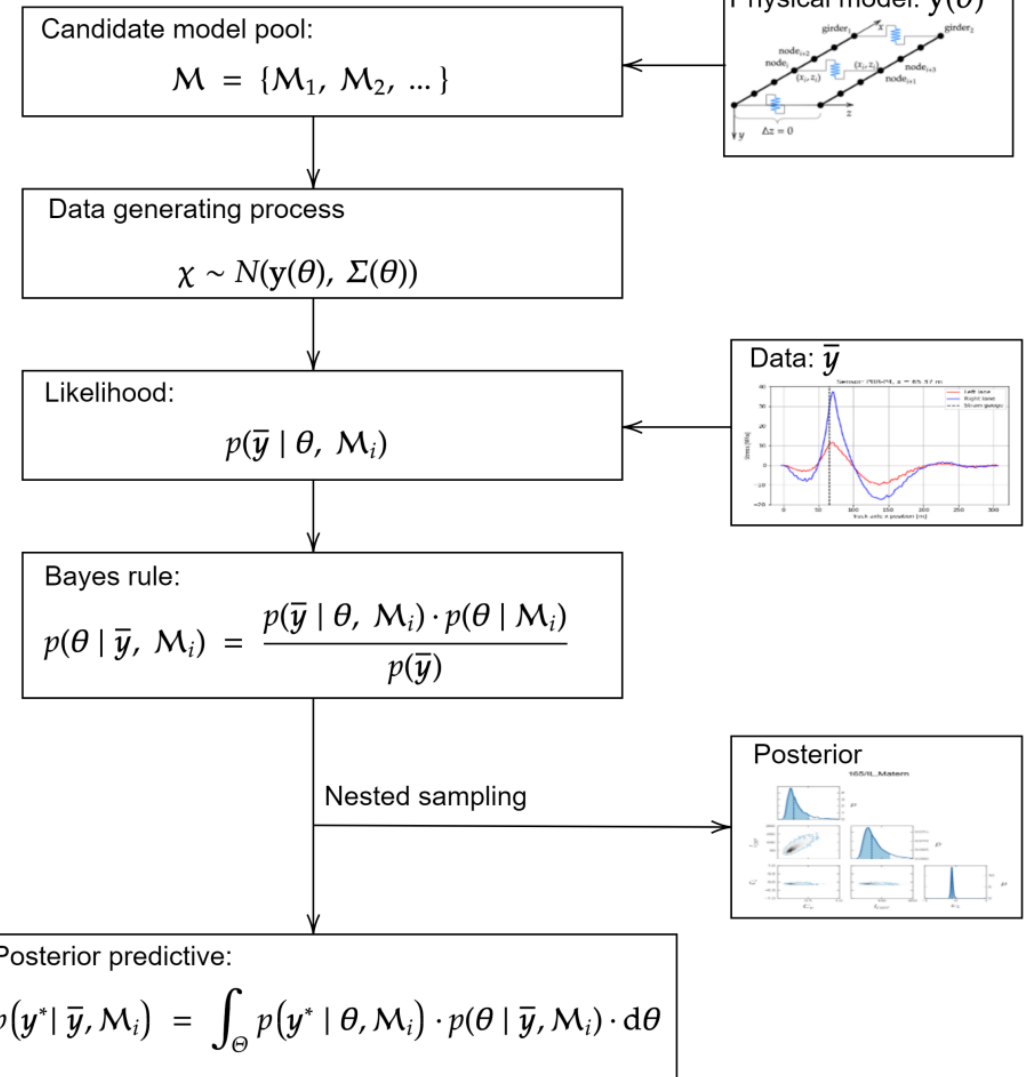
Pool of candidate models for spatial correlation

Inductive bias

Efficient calculation of loglikelihood (Multiplicative and additive model prediction error) for large datasets (10^2 - 10^4)



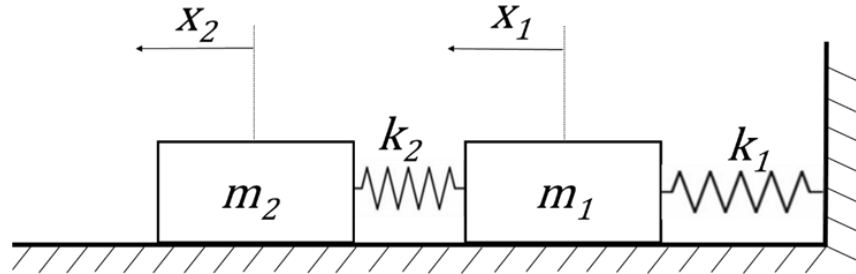
Gaussian model prediction error assumption



Efficient identification of multimodal posterior distributions

Physics – Guided ML

Cyclical Variational Bayes Monte Carlo

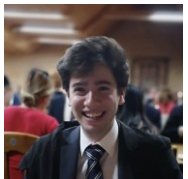
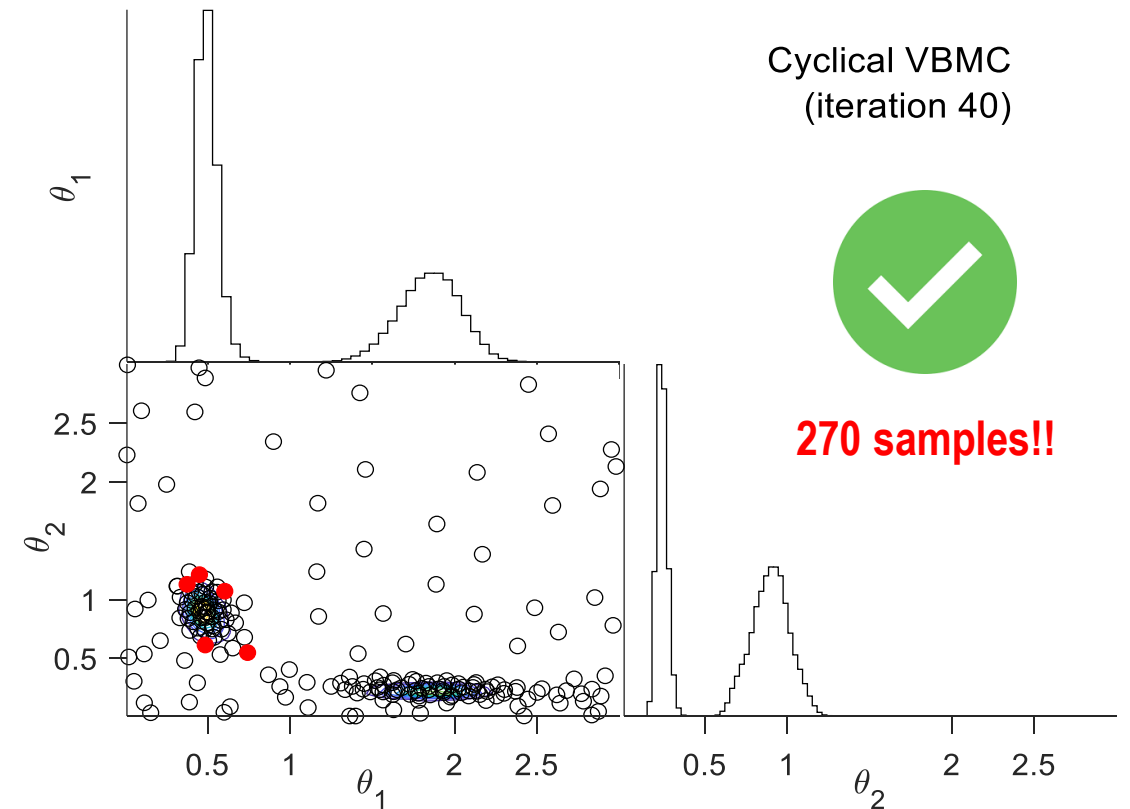
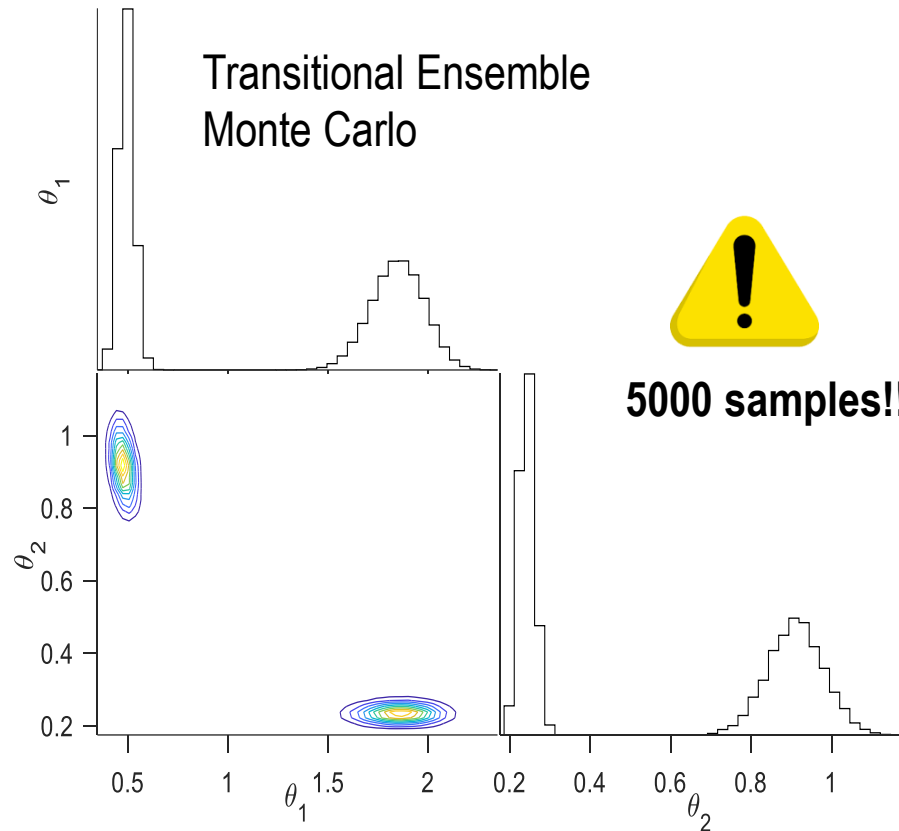


$$k_1 = \bar{k} \theta_1$$

$$k_2 = \bar{k} \theta_2$$

$$\theta_1 \sim U(0.01, 3)$$

$$\theta_2 \sim U(0.01, 3)$$

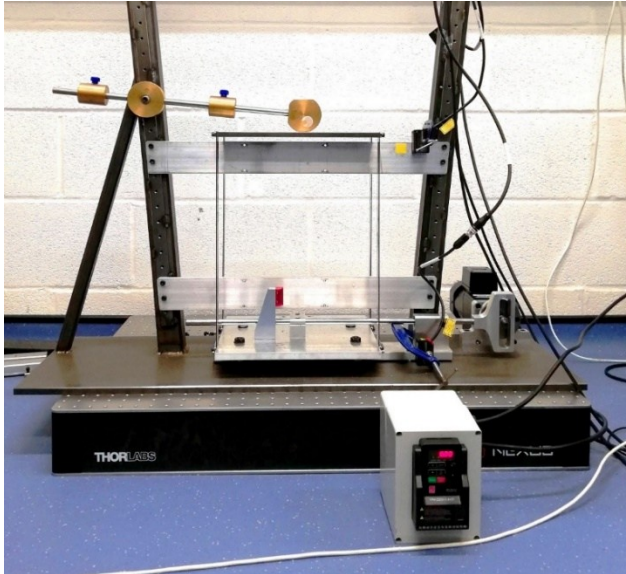


Real-world applications of PEML: lab setups

Datasets and codes available on the DVU group website!

Identifying governing equations and friction law or vibro-impact force **functional form**

Applied to SDOF frictional contact laboratory setup

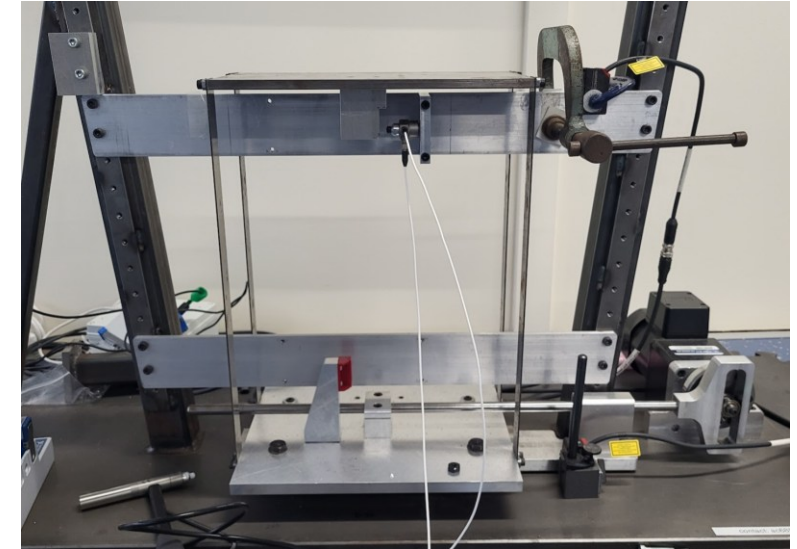


Switching **Gaussian Process** Latent force model



Marino, L., Cicirello, A., A switching Gaussian process latent force model for the identification of mechanical systems with a discontinuous nonlinearity, DCE, 2023

Applied to SDOF vibro-impact laboratory setup



Physics Enhanced
Sparse Identification



Lathourakis C., Cicirello, A., Physics Enhanced Sparse Identification of Dynamical Systems with Discontinuous Nonlinearities. Nonlinear Dynamics, 2024

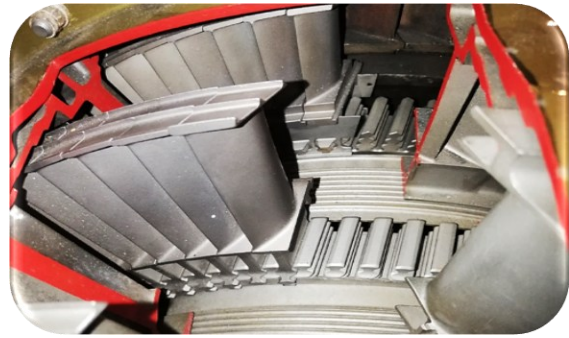
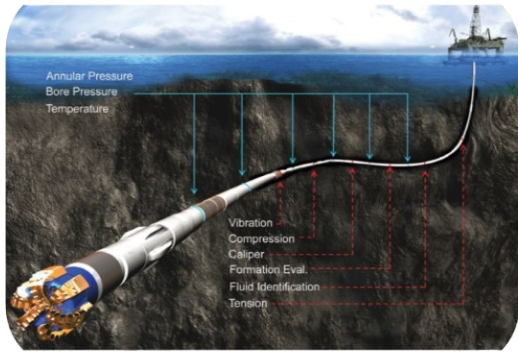


Jamie Lai
paper in the making

Physics-Encoded ML

Uncertainty in Knowledge: dealing with non-smooth nonlinearities

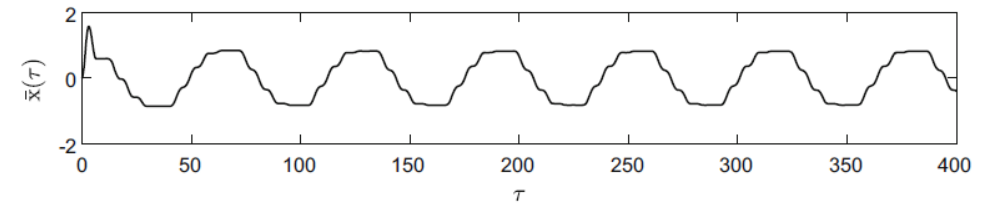
What friction **model**? What vibro-impact force function **model**?



Friction/Impact force **cannot be directly measured**

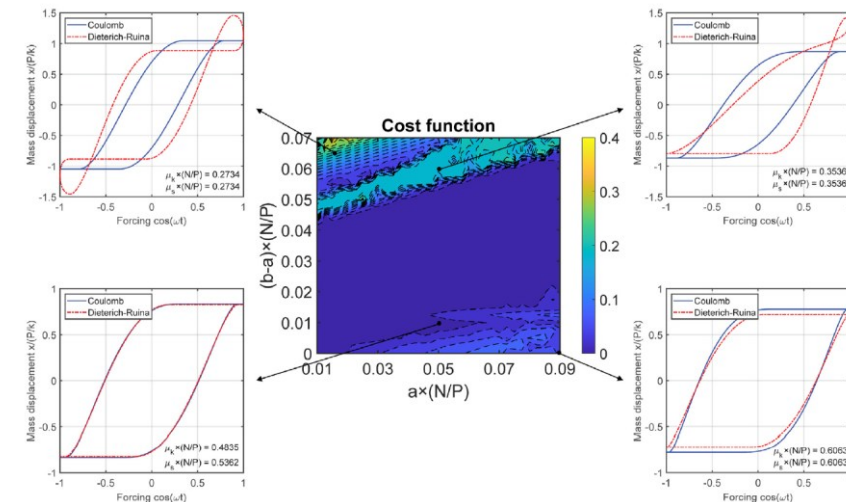
→ **Indirect** Data (sparse & Noisy)

Discontinuous and non-smooth nonlinear friction force leading to **multiple motion regimes, sharp response variations and & stiff numerical problems**



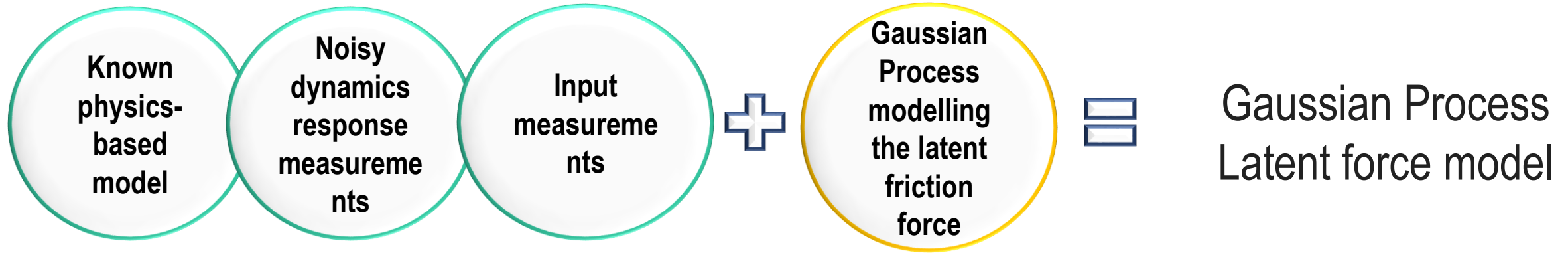
(a) Multiple steps stick-slip motion ($\tau = 0.1$, $F_\mu/F_k = 0.2$).

Two different friction laws can yield the same response! **Non-uniqueness**



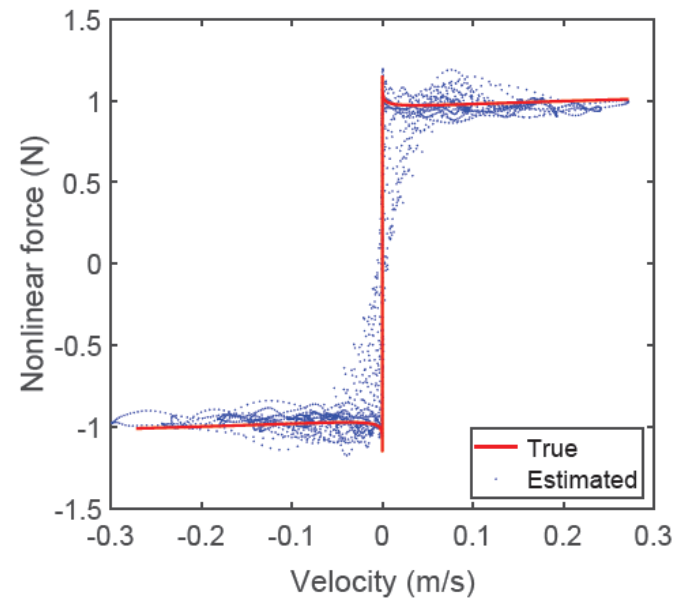
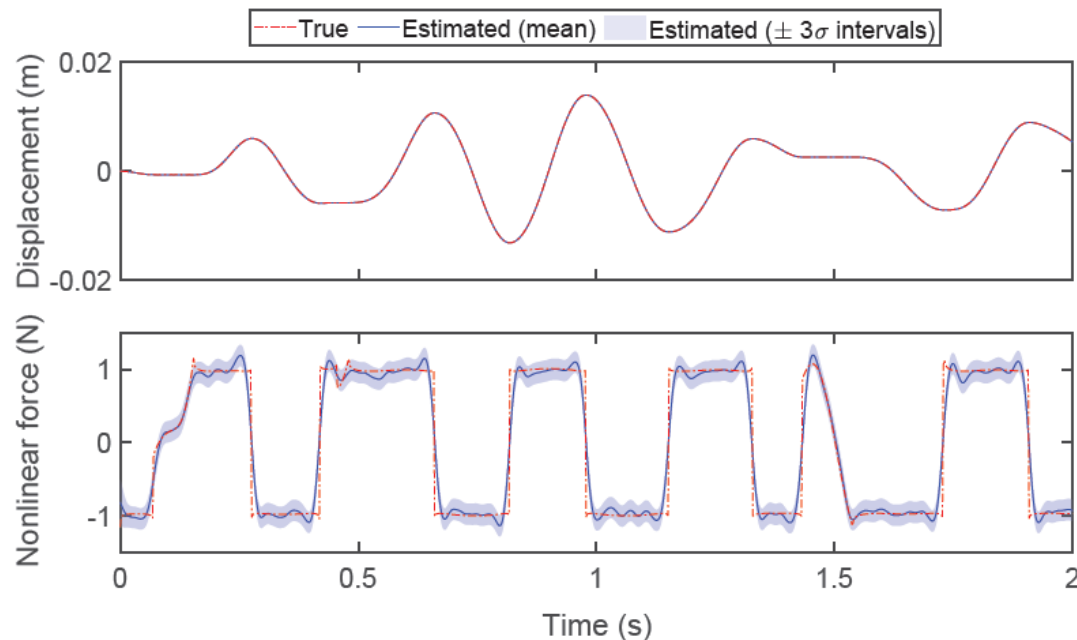
Caboi, A., Marino, L., Ciciello, A., A comparative study between Amontons-Coulomb and Dieterich-Ruina friction laws for the cyclic response of a single degree of freedom system, European Journal of Mechanics A - Solids, 2022.

Non-smooth NSID challenge 1: Identification of F-V curve + Force evolution and uncertainty even during stick-slip



$$m\ddot{\mathbf{z}} + c\dot{\mathbf{z}} + k\mathbf{z} + \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{z}, \dot{\mathbf{z}}) = u(t),$$

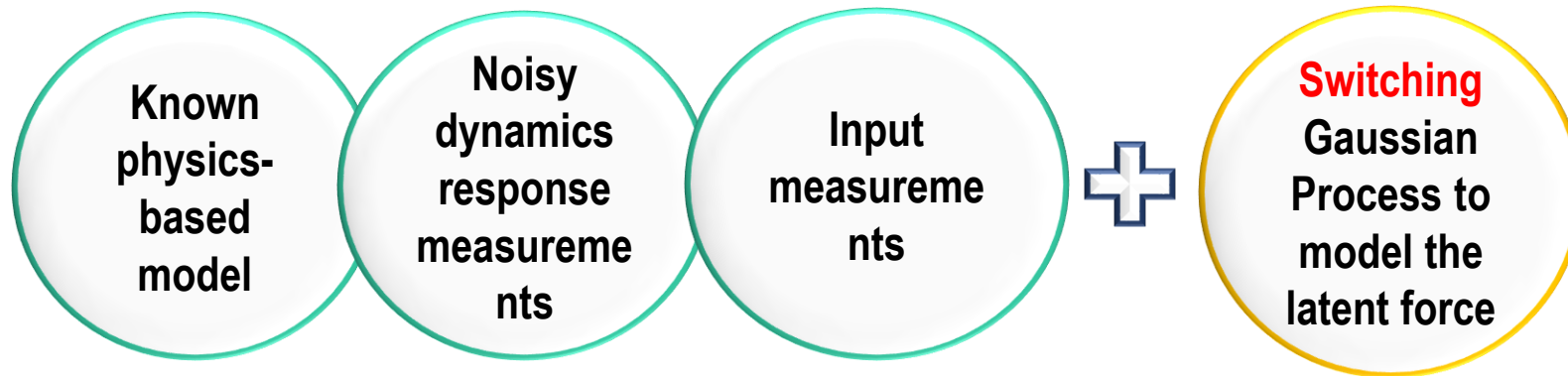
$$\mathbf{f} \sim \mathcal{GP}(0, \kappa_i(t, t'))$$



- Smoothed sharp variations
- Incorrect friction force description when the velocity is zero

Solution to challenge 1: Switching Gaussian Process Latent force model (**physics-encoded**) to obtain states, F-V curve, Force evolution and uncertainty even during stick-slip

$$m\ddot{\mathbf{z}} + c\dot{\mathbf{z}} + k\mathbf{z} + \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{z}, \dot{\mathbf{z}}) = u(t), \quad \mathbf{f} \sim \mathcal{GP}(0, \kappa_i(t, t'))$$



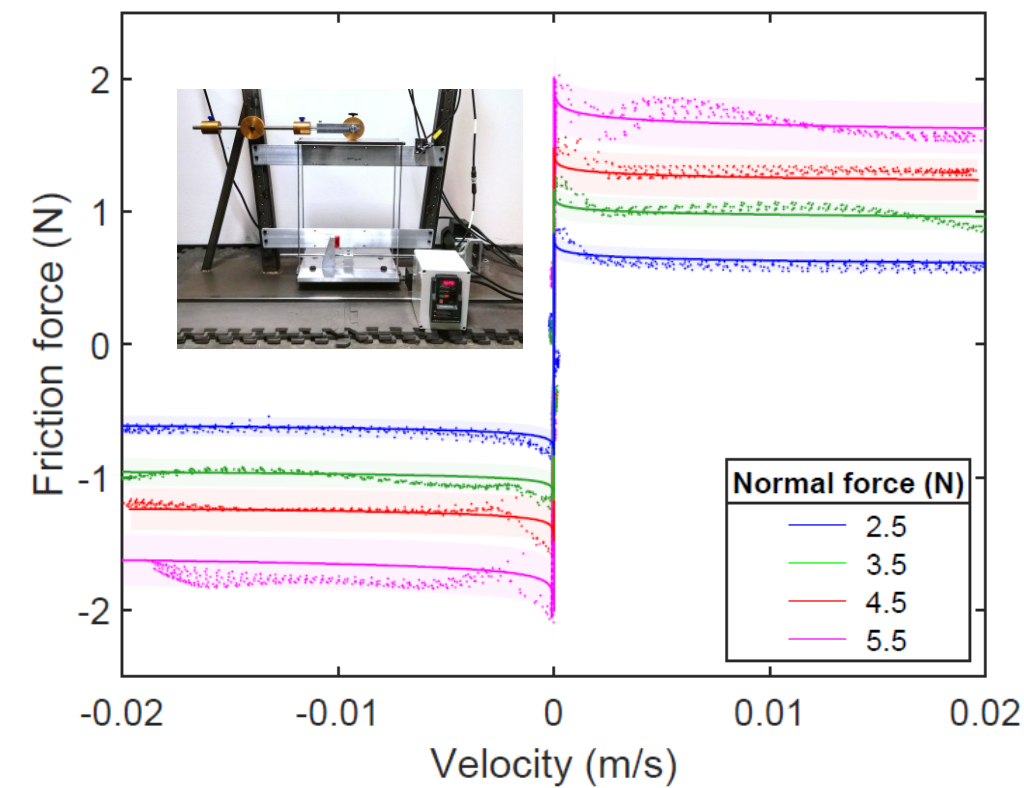
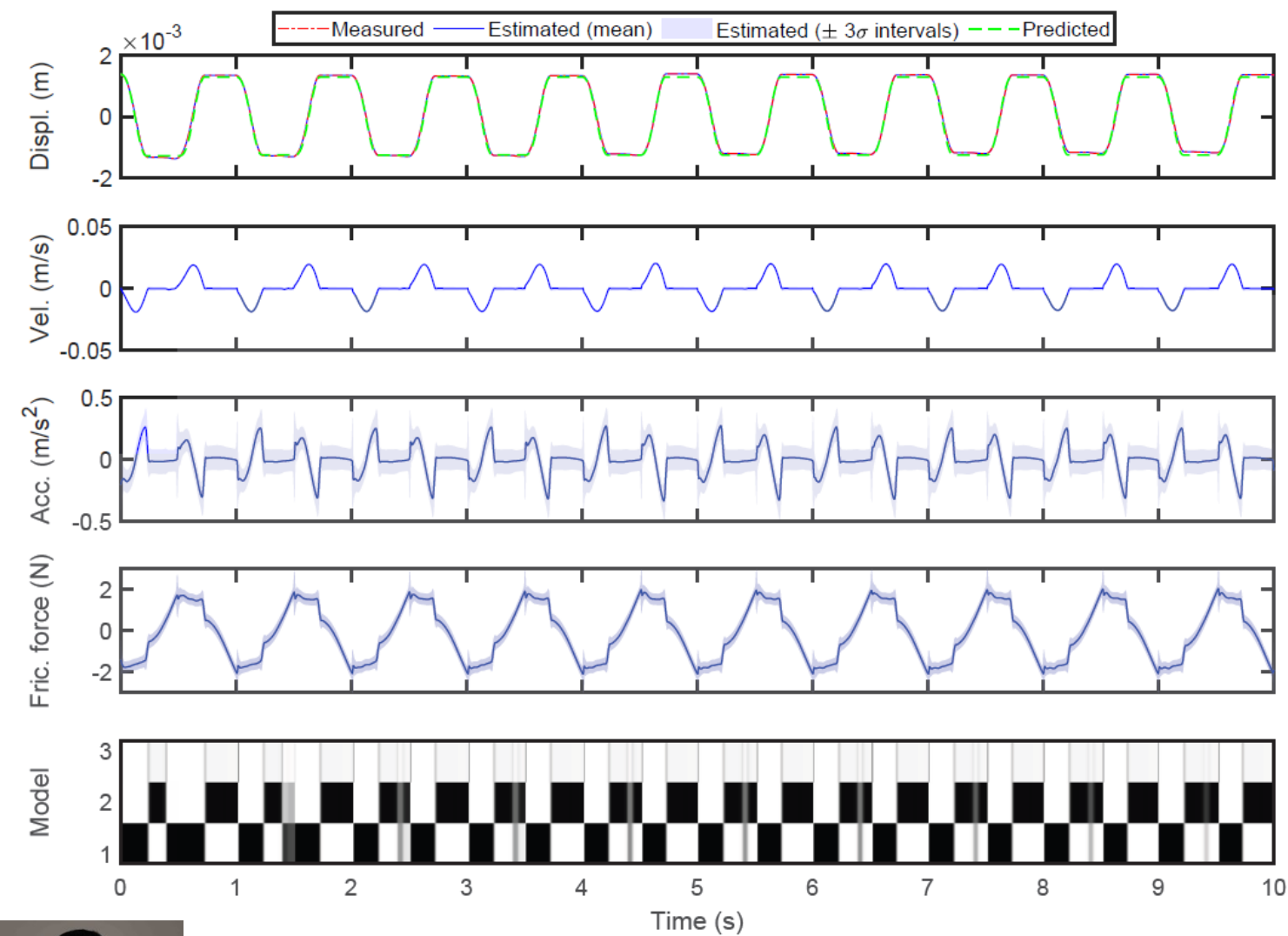
Switching models:

- **Sliding** response of a dry friction oscillator
- **Sticking** response of a dry friction oscillator
- Discontinuities in the latent friction force (**Resetting model**)

- Known partial model form (**discrepancy bias**);
- Specifying a set of latent force models & stick-slip constraints (**inductive bias**);
- Switching linear dynamics system governed by a discrete-time Markov model (**learning bias**)



Solution to challenge 1: Experimental validation



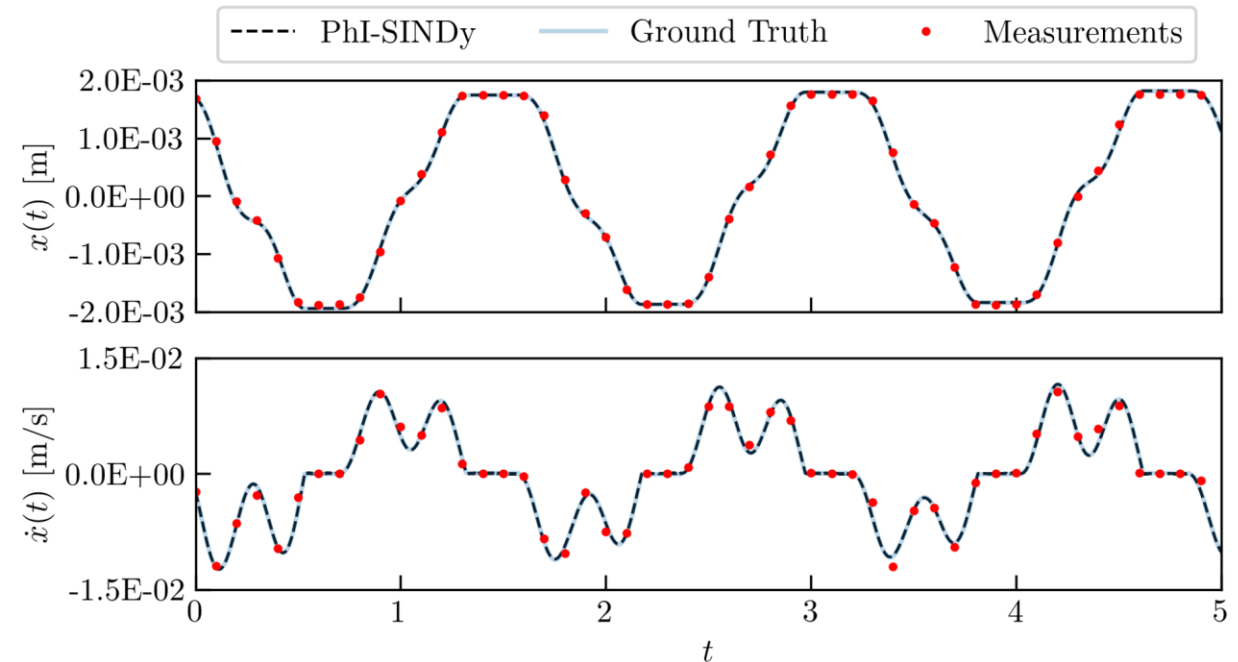
Non-smooth NSID challenge 2: identification of the governing equations and of the **correct friction law** with limited info → generalisable model

One set of (input-output) measurements + biases!

PhI-SINDy

- Obtain Sparse governing equation
 - Even for **high noise levels**
 - Even for **discontinuous nonlinearities**
- Applied to:
 - **MDOF systems**
 - **multiple friction nonlinearities**

Also validated with a laboratory experiment!



$$\begin{aligned}\text{Truth: } \dot{y} &= -0.0658 y - 386.36 x - 0.0856 \operatorname{sgn}(y) + 0.0658 \dot{u} + 386.36 u \\ \text{PhI-SINDy: } \dot{y} &= -0.0658 y - 386.36 x - 0.0855 \operatorname{sgn}(y) + 0.0658 \dot{u} + 386.36 u\end{aligned}$$

Learning something we did not know before: the friction law!



Our approach to uncertainty in **knowledge**: Physics Enhanced Sparse Identification of Dynamical Systems with Discontinuous Nonlinearities

➡
Physics-Encoded ML
➡

Discrepancy bias: known part of the equation

$$\frac{d}{dt} \mathbf{x}(t) = \underbrace{\mathbf{f}(t, \mathbf{x}(t))}_{\text{Unknown functional relationship}} + \underbrace{\mathbf{g}(t, \mathbf{x}(t))}_{\text{Discrepancy bias}}; \quad \mathbf{x}(t = 0) = \mathbf{x}_0$$

Learning bias: RK4, SGD, 1000 epochs, spectral method

$$\Theta(\mathbf{x}) = [1, x, x_{P_2}, \dots, \cos(\mathbf{x}), \dots, e^{-x}, e^{-2x}]^T$$

Inductive bias: Library of candidate of functions (user)

$\mathbf{x}_{\text{meas.}}(t) = [x_1(t), x_2(t), \dots, x_N(t)]^T$

ONE SET OF Time-series noisy and sparsely collected (input-output) measurements

$f_k(\mathbf{x}(t)) \approx \Theta(\mathbf{x}) \cdot \xi_k$

$\mathbf{x}_{\text{pred}}(t_{j+1}) \approx \text{RK4}(\mathbf{f}, \mathbf{g}, c, \mathbf{x}(t_j), t_{j+1} - t_j)$

$\xi_k = \min_{\Xi} \|\mathbf{x}_{\text{meas.}}(t) - \mathbf{x}_{\text{pred.}}(t)\| + \alpha \|\Xi\|_{l_1}$

PhI-SINDy

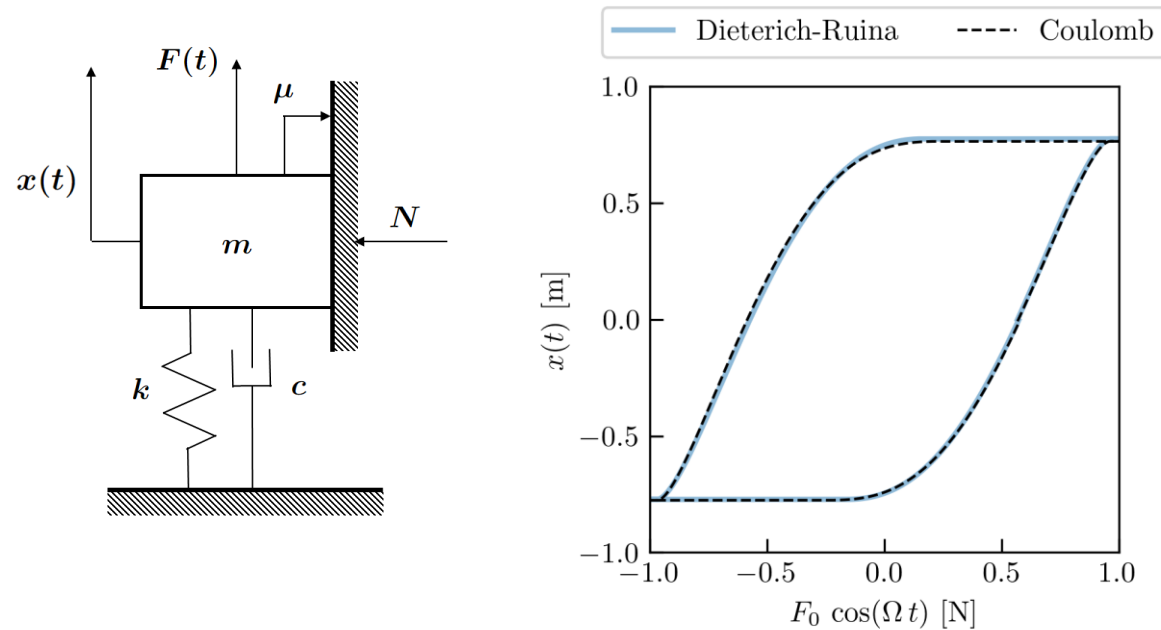
$$\frac{d}{dt} \mathbf{x}(t) = \Theta(\mathbf{x}) \xi_k + \mathbf{g}(\mathbf{x}(t))$$

Sparse coefficients

Inductive bias: Physics constraints (user)



PhI-SINDy results: distinguishing between two friction laws - synthetic case study



1. Displacement and velocity noisy measurements
2. Known linear part
3. Physics-constraints
4. Dictionary of candidate functions for friction force
(**inductive bias**)

$$\theta(x, y) = \left[1, x, y, \ln\left(\frac{|y|+\varepsilon}{V_*}\right), \ln\left(c + \frac{V_*}{|y|+\varepsilon}\right) \right]$$



(a) Ground truth: $\dot{y} = -0.1 y - x - 0.5 \operatorname{sgn}(y) + \cos(0.3 t)$
 PhI-SINDy: $\dot{y} = -0.1 y - x - 0.502 \operatorname{sgn}(y) + \cos(0.3 t)$

PhI-SINDy identified the correct friction law in this inverse problem

(b) Ground truth: $\left[0.5 + 0.05 \ln\left(\frac{|y|+10^{-6}}{0.003}\right) + 0.07 \ln\left(0.022 + \frac{0.003}{|y|+10^{-6}}\right) \right] \operatorname{sgn}(y)$
 PhI-SINDy: $\left[0.507 + 0.04 \ln\left(\frac{|y|+10^{-6}}{0.003}\right) + 0.056 \ln\left(0.022 + \frac{0.003}{|y|+10^{-6}}\right) \right] \operatorname{sgn}(y)$

Validated with lab experiments!



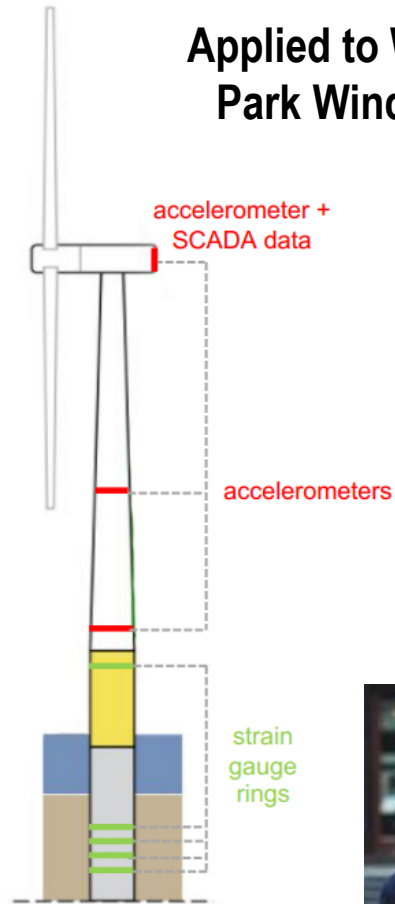
Known linear part

Real-world applications of PEML: OWT and Ferry Quay

Datasets and codes available on the DVU group website!

Obtaining unmeasured response states at inaccessible critical locations via virtual sensing

Applied to Westermeerwind
Park Wind Turbines data



Virtual sensing via Gaussian
Process Latent Force Models
(physics-encoded)



Zou J., Lourens E., Cicirello A., Virtual
sensing of subsoil strain response in
monopile-based offshore wind turbines
via Gaussian process latent force models,
MSSP, 2023.



Magerholm ferry quay

Virtual sensing and impact force
estimation for a Ferry Quay
(in collaboration with NTNU)
via Gaussian Process Latent
Force Models (physics-encoded)

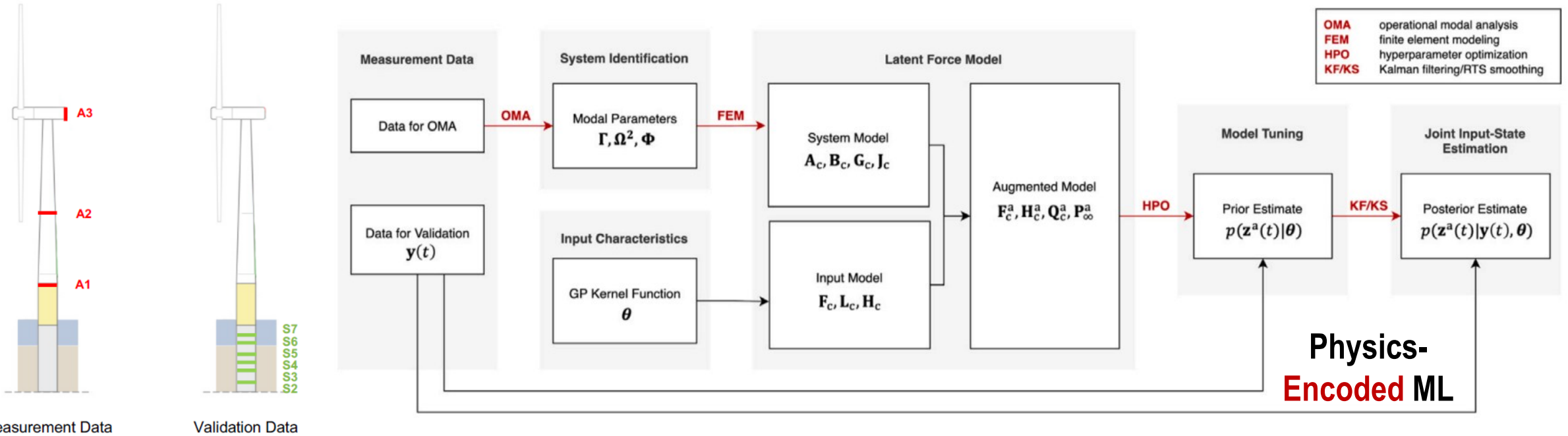


Sibille L., Nord T. S., Cicirello A., Digital twin
for virtual sensing of ferry quays via a Gaussian
Process Latent Force Model.
DCE, 2026

Physics-Encoded ML

Lead by Luigi Sibille, NTNU

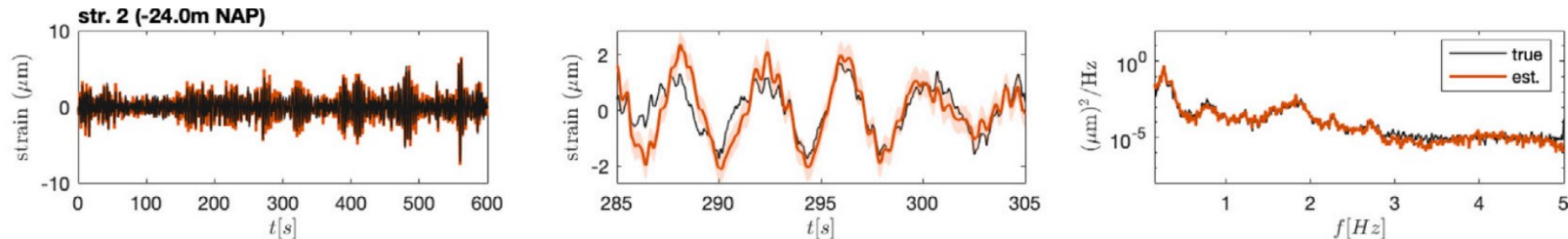
Obtaining unmeasured response states at inaccessible critical locations - Virtual sensing via Gaussian Process Latent Force Models



Measurement Data Validation Data

Westermeerwind Park,
The Netherlands

Results at S2 during the production state

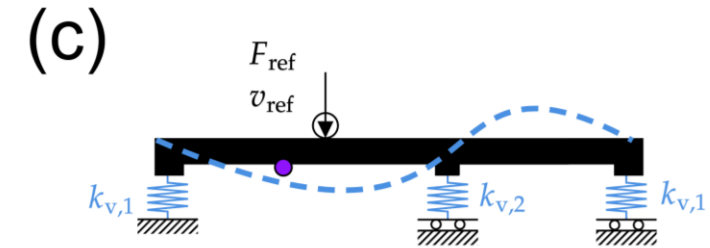
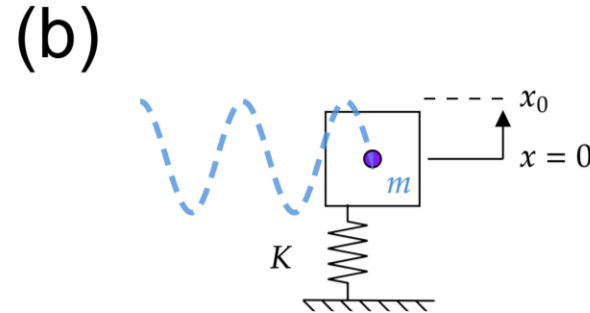
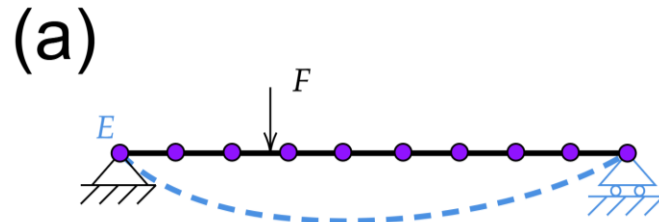


Zou J., Lourens E., Cicirello A., Virtual sensing of subsoil strain response in monopile-based offshore wind turbines via Gaussian process latent force models, Mechanical Systems and Signal Processing, 2023.

Dealing with corrupted data and partially known physics

Physics – Informed ML

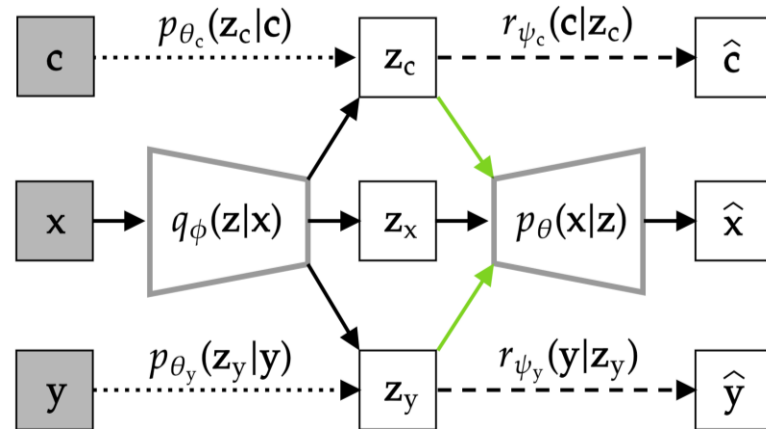
- **Physics might not be complete or correct...**
- Use measurements as they are to update **the incorrect model**: yield **wrong posteriors!**
- Need to **disentangle the measurements** to correctly assess uncertainty in the latent parameters!
- **Attribute measurements contributions**: (limited) modeled physics, environmental and operational influences, presence of damage



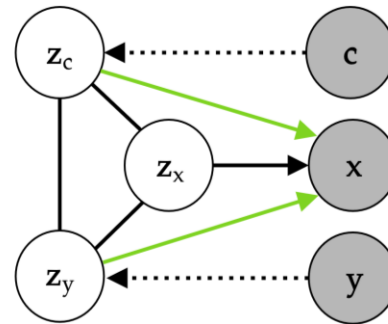
Physics-Informed Variational
Autoencoder for
disentanglement

Goal: identify and **attribute variability observed in *response measurements*** of an engineering system to variability stemming from the ***modeled physics, domain, and class influences***.

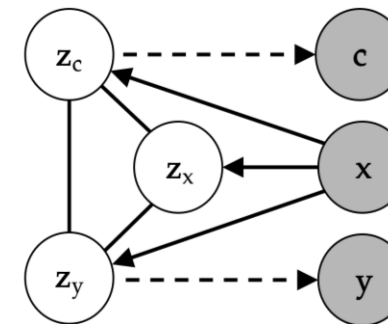
Nominal physics-based model



Generative model



Inference model



Dataset $\mathcal{D}=\{(\mathbf{x}_i, \mathbf{y}_i, \mathbf{c}_i)\}$, composed of N triplets of

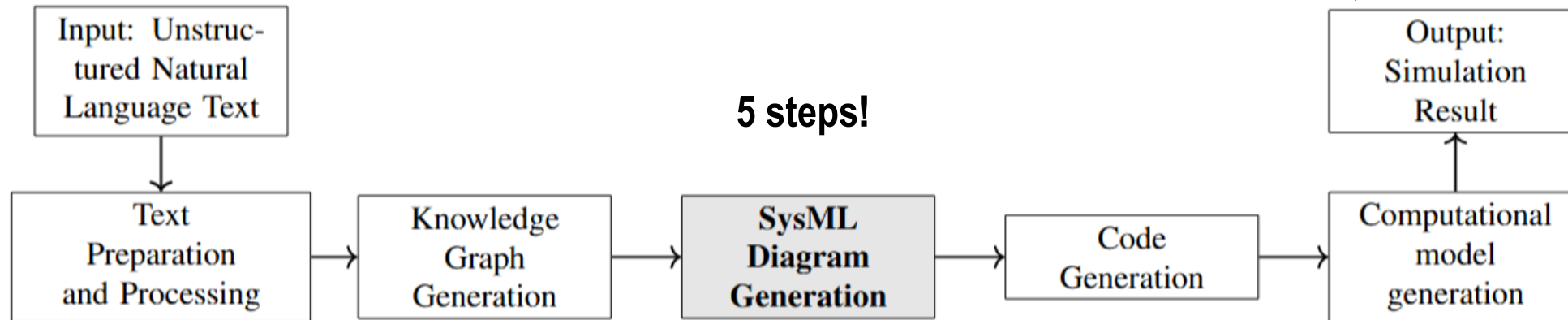
- response **measurements** $\mathbf{x}_i$
- **Domain variables** $\mathbf{c}_i$ (measurements of environmental and operational parameters)
- **Class variables** $\mathbf{y}_i$ (properties of the system that are cumbersome to obtain, e.g. damage condition from inspection reports)

Observed variable
 Unobserved variable
 Dependence
 Conditional prior
 Auxiliary task
 Gradient reversal

Important for correct **damage detection, model updating and distinction of confounding influences for critical infrastructures**

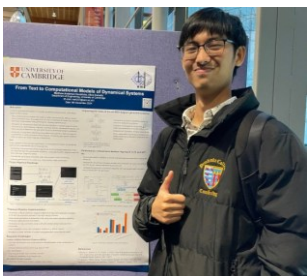


From Text to dynamical systems models: to speeding up the design and deployment of engineering dynamical systems!



- **System modeling language diagrams (SysML)** to extract accurate information about the dependencies, attributes, and operations of components.
- **Natural Language Processing (NLP)** strategies and Large Language Models (**LLMs**) to improve intermediate outputs of the SysML diagrams automated generation
- In code generation:
 - NLP strategies are used for summarization
 - LLMs are used for validation only.
- **Domain and expert knowledge integrated** by providing a set of equation implementation templates.

Improved performance compared to results yielded by LLMs only!



Matthew Hendricks

(Some of other) ongoing PEmL research within the DVU group

Time-evolving systems: wind turbines



Melisa Bosaci

Will be presented @ Eurodyn

Metamaterial designs under uncertainty



Niccolò Klinger

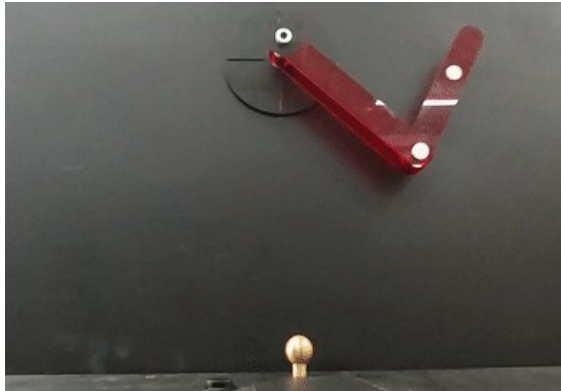


Will be presented @ Eurodyn

Physics-Informed Learning-based Operational Modal Analysis



Trajectory prediction of chaotic systems



Rob Seabourne

Will be presented @ IAM

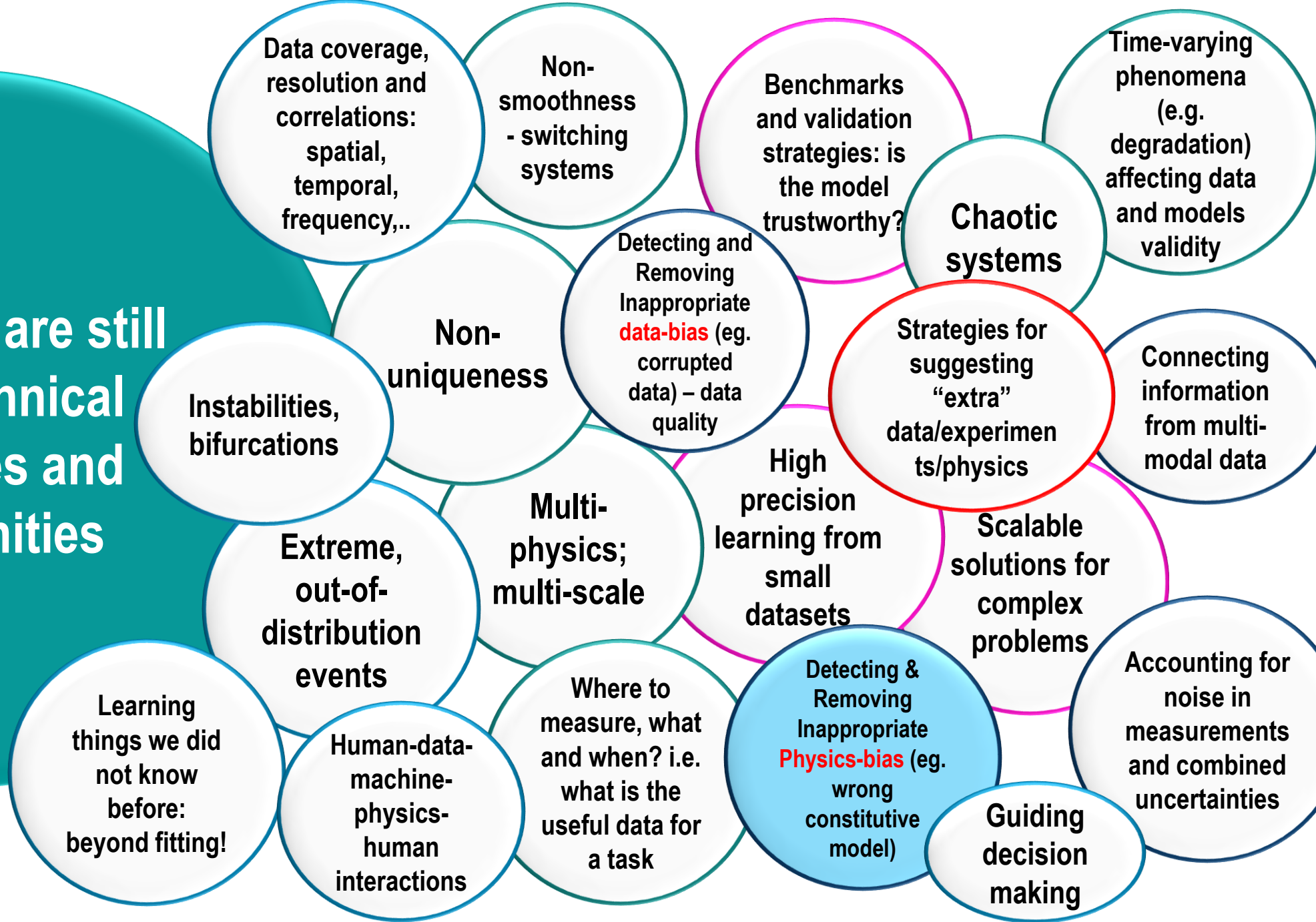


Mario Visconte
PhD Student (Unical),
Visiting Researcher (UCAM)

Will be presented @ ISMA

..And many more!!

...but there are still many technical challenges and opportunities



During this lecture you learned about

- PEML strategies
- Overview of PEML strategies developed within the DVU group

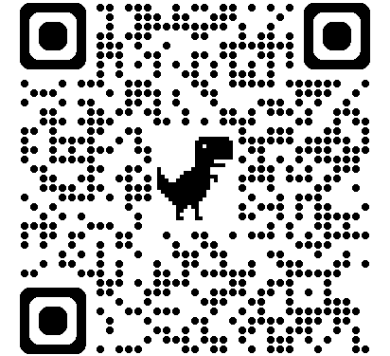


Next Lecture

- Hands-on PEML strategies!

Further readings

- **Deep Learning: foundations and concepts**, C. Bishop, H. Bishop (<https://www.bishopbook.com/>)
- **Pattern Recognition and machine learning**, C. Bishop (<https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/research/uploads/prod/2006/01/Bishop-Pattern-Recognition-and-Machine-Learning-2006.pdf>)
- **Deep Learning**, I. Goodfellow, Y. Bengio, A. Courville (<https://www.deeplearningbook.org/>)



I attempted to credit all the content/figures where I could find the original source. Sometimes the material is so widely used that it's difficult to be sure of the original author. Please let me know if you find missing references.